Project Planning Template

ServiceNow Incident Lifecycle Automation

1. Project Information

Field	Details
Project name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Project owner	
Developer / team	
Start date	
Target completion	
Instance / environment	
Version / last updated	

2. Project Overview

2.1 Problem statement

Describe the current incident handling problems (manual routing, missed SLAs, repeated incidents, scattered knowledge).

2.2 Objectives

- Automate the incident lifecycle from creation to resolution using workflows.
- Integrate Knowledge Management for faster resolution.
- Integrate Change Management to control fixes and reduce recurring incidents.
- Improve overall IT service efficiency.

2.3 Scope

In scope	Out of scope
Incident lifecycle, Business Rules, Flow Designer, notifications, SLAs, Knowledge and Change integration	Unapproved external integrations and production deployment are excluded unless agreed

3. Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
R1	Auto-calculate priority from impact and urgency	High	Planned
R2	Auto-assign by category and subcategory	High	Planned
R3	SLA tracking with warning and breach alerts	High	Planned
R4	Knowledge suggestion and article capture	Medium	Planned
R5	Raise and link Change Requests from incidents	Medium	Planned
R6	Automate incident lifecycle transitions and SLA tracking	High	Planned — pending implementation/verification

4. Work Breakdown and Schedule

#	Task	Start	End	Owner
1	Requirements and lifecycle design	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
2	Core configuration (forms, groups, SLAs)	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
3	Business Rules	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
4	Flow Designer flows	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
5	Knowledge Management integration	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
6	Change Management integration	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
7	Testing and UAT	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned
8	Deployment and documentation	To be scheduled	To be scheduled	Project team — to be assigned

5. Solution Design

Component	Planned design
Incident states	New, In Progress, On Hold, Resolved, Closed, Canceled

Component	Planned design
Business Rules	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
Flows	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
Notifications	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
SLA definitions	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
Knowledge integration	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
Change integration	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow
Reports / dashboards	Configure states, validation, assignment, notifications, and SLA rules in ServiceNow

6. Resources and Tools

- ServiceNow Personal Developer Instance (or project instance)
- Flow Designer, Business Rules, Notifications, SLA Definitions
- Knowledge Management and Change Management applications
- Update sets for moving configuration between instances

7. Risks and Mitigation

#	Risk	Level	Mitigation
1	Requirements change during development	Medium	Confirm scope in writing; use change control
2	Flows conflict with existing Business Rules	Medium	Document order of execution; test end to end
3	Low Knowledge article adoption	Medium	Prompt on resolution; track usage
4	Incomplete requirements or configuration errors	Medium	Review requirements, test in a non-production instance, and obtain stakeholder sign-off

8. Testing Plan

#	Test case	Expected result	Status
1	Create incident with impact and urgency	Priority set correctly	Not run
2	Resolve without resolution notes	Blocked with a message	Not run
3	Put On Hold without a reason	Blocked with a message	Not run
4	Raise Change Request from incident	Incident linked and On Hold	Not run
5	Resolve and create Knowledge article	Article created in draft	Not run
6	SLA breach scenario	Escalation notification sent	Not run

9. Success Criteria

- MTTR reduced against baseline:
- SLA compliance target:
- Incidents resolved with a Knowledge article:
- Reduction in recurring incidents:

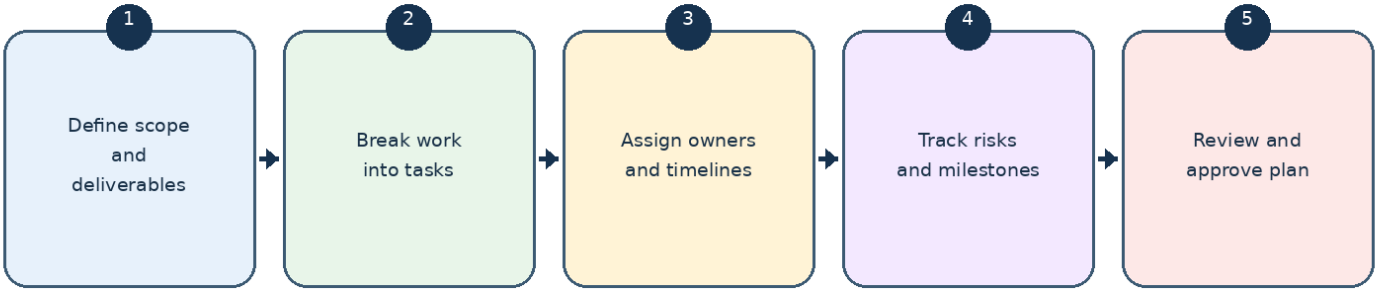
10. Approval

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Incident Lifecycle Automation	Project owner		To be confirmed by project team
Incident Lifecycle Automation	Reviewer		To be confirmed by project team

Process Diagram

Project Planning Template

Incident Lifecycle Automation • Process diagram



Expected output: a traceable, testable process with clear ownership and documented outcomes.